Table 71.1 Delimitation Commissions constituted so far

Delimitation Commission	Established in	Established under the Act
First	1952	The Delimitation Commission Act, 1952
Second	1963	The Delimitation Commission Act, 1962
Third	1973	The Delimitation Act, 1972
Fourth	2002	The Delimitation Act, 2002

Constitutional Provisions

Articles 81, 82, 170, 330 and 332 of the Constitution of India deal with the delimitation of the Parliamentary and Assembly Constituencies. These Articles were amended by the 84th Constitutional Amendment Act of 2001 and the 87th Constitutional Amendment Act of 2003. The cumulative effect of these two amendments to the Constitution is as follows[5]:

1. The total number of existing seats as allocated to various states in the Lok Sabha on the basis of 1971 census shall remain unaltered till the first census to be taken after the year 2026
2. The total number of existing seats in the Legislative Assemblies of all states[6] as fixed on the basis of 1971 census shall also remain unaltered till the first census to be taken after the year 2026
3. The number of seats to be reserved for the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes in the Lok Sabha and State Legislative Assemblies shall be re-worked out on the basis of 2001 census
4. Each state shall be redelimited into territorial parliamentary and assembly constituencies on the basis of 2001 census and the extent of such constituencies as delimited now shall remain frozen till the first census to be taken after the year 2026
5. The constituencies shall be so re-delimited that population (on the basis of 2001 census) of each parliamentary and assembly constituency in a state shall, so far as practicable, be the same throughout the state

Fourth Delimitation Commission

In pursuance of the above mentioned provisions of the Constitution, the Parliament enacted the Delimitation Act, 2002 and provided for the establishment of a Delimitation Commission. The Commission's task under the Constitution and the Delimitation Act of 2002[7] was to readjust the Parliamentary and Assembly constituencies in all the states of India (except the erstwhile state of Jammu and Kashmir) on the basis of 2001 census.

The Fourth Delimitation Commission of 2002 was a three-member body. It consisted of the following:

1. The Chairperson who was to be either a serving or a retired judge of the Supreme Court